

Stefano Sangiovanni

PhD Candidate in Political Science • Milan, Italy

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Education

NASP Graduate School, University of Milan

Oct. 2023 – Present

PhD Candidate in Political Science

Milan, Italy

Supervisors: Prof. [Andrea Ceron](#) and Prof. [Giovanna M. Invernizzi](#).

Dissertation: “The Balance Between Positional and Valence Issues in Party Competition”.

Research interests: party competition, valence politics, electoral behavior, computational social science, quantitative text analysis, survey experiments.

Trinity College Dublin

Jan. 2026 – Apr. 2026

Visiting PhD Researcher

Dublin, Ireland

Sponsor: Prof. [Constantine Boussalis](#).

University of Mannheim

Apr. 2025 – May 2025

Visiting PhD Researcher

Mannheim, Germany

Visiting Fellowship at the Mannheim Centre for European Social Research (MZES).

University of Milan

Oct. 2020 – Mar. 2023

MA in Administration and Public Policy, 110/110 with honours

Milan, Italy

University of Milan-Bicocca

Oct. 2017 – Oct. 2020

BA in Sociology

Milan, Italy

Publications & Manuscripts

Revise & Resubmit

Sangiovanni, S. “Who Cares About Valence Issues? Issue Priorities Among Voters of Valence Populist Parties.” *Electoral Studies*.

Sangiovanni, S. “When Valence Strategies Increase Polling Support: Evidence from Electoral Campaigns.” *Journal of Elections, Public Opinion and Parties*.

Under Review

Ceron, A., Negri, F., & **Sangiovanni, S.** “What Does It Mean? A Survey Experiment on the Efficacy of Explaining the Means to Pursue a Policy Proposal.”

Sangiovanni, S. & Celebrin, G. “Generational Perspectives on Democracy: Migrants’ Satisfaction Across National and European Levels.”

Taddei, F., & **Sangiovanni, S.** “Just a Football Match? Italian Terraces’ Banners Analysis.”

Working Papers

Sangiovanni, S., Ceron, A., & Invernizzi, G. “Investigating Political Scandals: Combining Conjoint Analysis and Audio-Based Experiments.”

Sangiovanni, S. “Valence Beyond the Label: Identifying and Measuring Evaluative Competition in Party Politics.”

Sangiovanni, S. “Clarity of Responsibility and Macroeconomic Accountability in Parliamentary Debate.”

Selected Work in Progress

Ruggeri, A., Masullo, J., & **Sangiovanni, S.** “Attitudes Toward Political Violence in Italy: A Survey Experimental Approach.”

Ceron, A., Negri, F., & **Sangiovanni, S.** “Seeing the Populist Through Populist Eyes: Citizen Populism and the Image of the Populist Politician.”

Sangiovanni, S. “Feeding the Cycle of Negativity: Exploring the Media’s Influence on the Tone of Electoral Campaigns.”

Sangiovanni, S. “Historical Anchoring and Ideological Over-Coherence in LLM-Based Synthetic Respondents.”

Conference & Seminar Presentations

- 2026** European Consortium for Political Research (ECPR) General Conference. Kraków, 8–11 Sept. 2026. *Scheduled presentation.*
- 2026** Italian Political Science Association (SISP) Annual Conference. Trieste, 3–5 Sept. 2026. *Scheduled presentation.*
- 2026** European Political Science Society (EPSS) Annual Conference. ICC Belfast, 18–20 June 2026. *Scheduled presentation.*
- 2026** PolMeth Europe. Trinity College Dublin, 14–15 May 2026. *Clarity of Responsibility and Macroeconomic Accountability in Parliamentary Debate.*
- 2026** Quantitative and Computational Analysis of Text, Image and Video-as-Data (COMPTTEXT). Birmingham, 23–25 Apr. 2026. *Clarity of Responsibility and Macroeconomic Accountability in Parliamentary Debate.*
- 2026** Political Institutions, Parties & Public Opinion Seminars. University of Milan, 14 Apr. 2026. *Analyzing Representation and Strategic Party Communication in Parliamentary Debates.* With J. Diener.
- 2025** BAGSS Workshop on Computational Text Analysis in Party Research. University of Bamberg, 25–26 Sept. 2025. *Economic Performance Indicators and Strategic Valence Choices.*
- 2025** Social Science Methodology Conference (RC33). University of Naples, 22–25 Sept. 2025. *Generational Perspectives on Democracy: Migrants' Satisfaction Across National and European Levels.* With G. Celebrin.
- 2025** Italian Political Science Association (SISP) Annual Conference. University of Naples, 4–6 Sept. 2025.
- 2025** MetRiSP Workshop. MetRiSP Network, 3 Sept. 2025. *Methods for Political Science Research in the Age of Artificial Intelligence.*
- 2025** Collegio Carlo Alberto Days. Collegio Carlo Alberto, Turin. *When Valence Strategies Increase Polling Support: Evidence from Electoral Campaigns.*
- 2025** MZES-DVPW Methods of Political Science. University of Mannheim. *Investigating Political Scandals: Combining Conjoint Analysis and Audio-Based Experiments.* With A. Ceron and G. M. Invernizzi.
- 2024** POLS PIRSS Seminar Series. University of Milan. *Analyzing Public Perceptions of Government Actions and Political Scandals Through Survey Experimental Designs.* With U. Platini.
- 2024** Italian Political Science Association (SISP) Annual Conference. University of Trieste, 12–14 Sept. 2024.
- 2024** Collegio Carlo Alberto Days. Collegio Carlo Alberto, Turin. *Valence Theory and Political Scandals: A Proposal of a Conjoint Experiment.*
- 2022** Jean Monnet Centres of Excellence. University of Milan. *European Emission Trading System: The Impact of EU-ETS on Costs and Benefits.* With A. Lombardi, M. Nascone, and E. Rossoni.

Teaching & Tutoring

Teaching Assistantships

Data Science for Organisations

BA in Management of Organisation and Labour, University of Milan
Applied tutorials in R. Course taught by prof. Cremonini

A.Y. 2026/27

Milan, Italy

Data Visualization for Management

BA in Management of Organisation and Labour, University of Milan
Applied tutorials in Python. Course taught by prof. Cremonini.

A.Y. 2026/27

Milan, Italy

Italian Political System

BA in Political Science, University of Milan
Oral examinations and course-related student support. Course taught by prof. Ceron.

A.Y. 2025/26

Milan, Italy

Public Policies

BA in Organisational Sciences, University of Milan-Bicocca
Two lectures, support for student group activities. Course taught by prof. Negri.

A.Y. 2025/26

Milan, Italy

Academic Tutoring

Bachelor's Degree Course in Political Science

A.Y. 2023/24 – 2025/26

University of Milan	<i>Milan, Italy</i>
Academic tutoring and student support for the undergraduate programme in Political Science.	
Master's Degree Course in Politics, Philosophy and Public Affairs	A.Y. 2024/25
University of Milan	<i>Milan, Italy</i>
Academic tutoring and student support for Master's students in Politics, Philosophy and Public Affairs.	

Guest Lectures

Public Policy	A.Y. 2025/26
BA in Organisational Sciences, University of Milan-Bicocca	
"Introduction to Survey Experiments", "Ordinary Least Squares (OLS): Intuition and Interpretation" - Lecture slides .	
Political Sociology	A.Y. 2023/24 – 2024/25
BA in International Sciences and European Institutions, University of Milan	
"Measuring Democracy: Theory and Practice" - Lecture slides .	
Politics, Philosophy and Public Affairs	A.Y. 2024/25
Thesis Seminars for Master's Students, University of Milan	
"How to Plan a Social Sciences Research Design", "Introduction to Qualitative Research" - Lecture slides .	

Summer Schools & Methods Training

Adapters: Lightweight Machine Learning for Social Science Research, GESIS	June 2025
Adapter-based fine-tuning of large language models in Python.	
Large Language Models for Political Scientists, Italian Political Science Association	Sept. 2024
Hands-on training on the use of large language models for political science research.	
Summer Institute in Computational Social Science (SICSS), University of Bologna	June 2024
Two-week summer school on computational methods, with competitive selection process.	
RECSM Winter Methods School, Universitat Pompeu Fabra	Mar. 2023
Network Analysis and Visualization with R.	
RECSM Summer Methods School, Universitat Pompeu Fabra	June 2022
Introduction to Python, Introduction to R, Survey Methodology and Survey Design.	

Awards, Grants & Fellowships

2026	COMPTTEXT 2026 Travel Grant.
2025	Visiting PhD Fellowship , Mannheim Centre for European Social Research (MZES).
2025	MetRiSP Workshop Travel Grant, awarded by SISP, GPR, and ECPR's Standing Group on Political Methodology.
2025	MZES-DVPW Conference Travel Grant for Early-Career Researchers.
2023	PhD Scholarship, Department of Social and Political Sciences, University of Milan.

Research & Professional Experience

Research Assistant	Oct. 2020 – Dec. 2020
<i>Global Media Monitoring Project, University of Milan-Bicocca, Italy</i>	
Collected and analyzed tweets from seven Italian newspapers as part of the Global Media Monitoring Project, in collaboration with the University of Milan-Bicocca research group. Italian GMMP 2020 Report .	
Conference Organization Team Member	Sept. 2023
<i>ESPAnet 2023, University of Milan, Italy</i>	
Supported conference logistics, session organization, student coordination, and preparation of conference materials.	
Tutoring Online Project	Oct. 2022 – Mar. 2023
<i>Bocconi University – Harvard University, Milan, Italy</i>	
Delivered over 40 hours of tutoring in Mathematics, English, and Italian to support students with financial and learning difficulties.	

Memberships

- Since 2026 COMPTExT
- Since 2025 European Political Science Society (EPSS)
- Since 2024 Italian Political Science Association (SISP)

Skills

Languages	English (IELTS Academic Band 8, C1), Italian (native), Spanish (A2)
Programming Languages	R, Python, L ^A T _E X, SQL
Data Analysis Tools	STATA, Meta Content Library, Tableau, SPSS
Developer Tools	Git, GitHub, Visual Studio Code, Jupyter Notebook
Live Streaming Tools	OBS Studio, OBS Ninja, StreamElements
GIS Tools	QGIS